

[NT Lesson 6](#): “They Straightway Left Their Nets” (See NTL6 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us understand that Apostles are called to be special witnesses of Jesus Christ and that we are blessed when we sustain and follow them.

1. Jesus announces that he is the Messiah.

• Read [Luke 4:14-32](#). And he said “unto them, This day is this scripture fulfilled in your ears.” (See [Isaiah 61:1-2](#))

†1. Jesus the Christ, Ch. 13.

Why do you think the people in the synagogue had difficulty accepting Jesus as the Messiah?

Why do you think some people today have difficulty accepting Jesus Christ?

How can we strengthen our testimonies that Jesus is the Savior?

2. Jesus calls his Twelve Apostles.

• Read [Luke 5:1-11, 27-28](#) and [Luke 6:12-16](#). “And ... they forsook all, and followed him.”

How did Jesus describe their new work? (See Luke 5:10 “Fear not; from henceforth thou shalt catch men.”)

How has your life been affected because of your decision to follow Jesus Christ?

What can we learn from Christ about being “fishers of men”? (Mark 1:17).

- Luke 5:5. “At thy word I will let down the net.” (They would work where Jesus directed them.)
- Luke 5:6. “They inclosed a great multitude of fishes: and their net brake.” (They would find many people who would accept the gospel.)
- Luke 5:7. “They beckoned unto their partners ... that they should come and help them.” (They would call others to assist in the work.)

“Jesus called Peter, James, and John to be his disciples. Later he would call them to be Apostles.” (*Lesson Manual*)

Disciple: (See Bible Dictionary, “[Disciple](#),” 657.)

Apostle: (See Bible Dictionary, “[Apostle](#),” 612).

What is the difference between a disciple and an Apostle?

Why was it important that Jesus call Apostles?

(See Matthew 9:36-38; 16-19; Mark 3:14-15; John 20:19-21, 23; Ephesians 4:11-15.)

• Luke 6:12-13. He “went out into a mountain to pray, and continued all night in prayer to God.”

• Luke 5:5, 8, 11, 27-28 and [D&C 4:3, 5-6](#).

What do these verses tell us about the men whom Jesus called as His Apostles?

How does a person become qualified to serve the Lord?

3. Jesus ordains and instructs the Twelve Apostles.

• [Matthew 10](#). “And when he called unto him his twelve disciples, he gave them power ...”

What do we learn about the powers and responsibilities of Apostles from Jesus’ counsel in Matthew 10?

(See Matthew 10:1, 6-7, 8, 11-14, 19-20, 39.)

How do the powers and responsibilities given to the original Apostles compare with latter-day Apostles?

(See [D&C 107:23, 33, 35](#) and [D&C 112:14, 19-22, 30-31](#).)

What blessings are promised to those who follow the Apostles?

(See [Matthew 10:40-42](#) and [D&C 124:45-46](#).) †2. Elder Spencer W. Kimball

†3. Boyd K. Packer †4. Ted L. Gibbons

Next Week: L7 “[He] Took Our Infirmities, and Bare Our Sicknesses”; See L7: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

†1. **Jesus the Christ, Chapter 13:** “Handing the book to the minister, He sat down. It was allowable for the reader in the service of the Jewish synagogue to make comments in explanation of what had been read; but to do so he must sit. When Jesus took His seat the people knew that he was about to expound the text, and ‘the eyes of all them that were in the synagogue were fastened on him.’ The scripture He had quoted was one recognized by all classes as specifically referring to the Messiah, for whose coming the nation waited. The first sentence of our Lord’s commentary was startling; it involved no labored analysis, no scholastic interpretation, but a direct and unambiguous application: ‘This day is this scripture fulfilled in your ears.’ There was such graciousness in His words that all wondered, and they said, ‘Is not this Joseph’s son?’

“Jesus knew their thoughts even if He heard not their words, and, forestalling their criticism, He said: ‘Ye will surely say unto me this proverb, Physician, heal thyself: whatsoever we have heard done in Capernaum, do also here in thy country. And he said, Verily I say unto you, No prophet is accepted in his own country.’ In their hearts the people were eager for a sign, a wonder, a miracle. They knew that Jesus had wrought such in Cana, and a boy in Capernaum had been healed by His word; at Jerusalem too He had astonished the people with mighty works. Were they, His townsmen, to be slighted? Why would He not treat them to some entertaining exhibition of His powers? He continued His address, reminding them that in the days of Elijah, when for three years and a half no rain had fallen, and famine had reigned, the prophet had been sent to but one of the many widows, and she a woman of Sarepta in Sidon, a Gentile, not a daughter of Israel. And again, though there had been many lepers in Israel in the days of Elisha, but one leper, and he a Syrian, not an Israelite, had been cleansed through the prophet’s ministration, for Naaman alone had manifested the requisite faith.

“Then great was their wrath. Did He dare to class them with Gentiles and lepers? Were they to be likened unto despized [*sic*] unbelievers, and that too by the son of the village carpenter, who had grown from childhood in their community? Victims of diabolical rage, they seized the Lord and took Him to the brow of the hill on the slopes of which the town was built, determined to avenge their wounded feelings by hurling Him from the rocky cliffs. Thus early in His ministry did the forces of opposition attain murderous intensity... ‘But He passing through the midst of them went his way.’” (*Jesus the Christ*, Chapter 13, commentary on Luke 4:14-32.)

†2. **Elder Spencer W. Kimball:** “In many other places Paul also warned us against the deceivers who would come even before his departing. And they have continued to come, and they are among us today. The authorities which the Lord has placed in his Church constitute for the people of the Church a harbor, a place

of refuge, a hitching post, as it were. No one in this Church will ever go far astray who ties himself securely to the Church Authorities whom the Lord has placed in his Church. This Church will never go astray; the Quorum of the Twelve will never lead you into bypaths; it never has and never will. There could be individuals who would falter; there will never be a majority of the Council of the Twelve on the wrong side at any time. The Lord has chosen them; he has given them specific responsibilities. And those who stand close to them will be safe. And conversely, whenever one begins to go his own way in opposition to authority, he is in grave danger. I would not say that those leaders whom the Lord chooses are necessarily the most brilliant, nor the most highly trained, but they are the chosen, and when chosen of the Lord they are his recognized authority, and the people who stay close to them have safety.” (Conference Report, [Apr. 1951, 104](#)).

†3. **Boyd K. Packer:** “On one occasion [Karl G. Maeser] was leading a party of young missionaries across the Alps. As they slowly ascended the steep slope, he looked back and saw a row of sticks thrust into the glacial snow to mark the one safe path across the otherwise treacherous mountains.

“Something about those sticks impressed him, and halting the company of missionaries he gestured toward them and said, ‘Brethren, there stands the priesthood. They are just common sticks like the rest of us—some of them may even seem to be a little crooked, but the position they hold makes them what they are. If we step aside from the path they mark, we are lost’” (Boyd K. Packer, *BYU Speeches*, March 23, 1965, p. 10; cited in Ted L. Gibbons, [Lesson #6, “They Straightway Left Their Nets,”](#) accessed 2/13/15.)

†4. **Ted L. Gibbons:** “I once handed blank papers to my students in a Seminary class and invited them to write the names of every vocal star and singing group they could remember. One boy wrote over 100 in the time allowed! Then I asked them to turn the paper over and write the names of the First Presidency and Quorum of the Twelve in order. This same boy wrote the name of the Prophet (spelled wrong) and he was done. How important is it to know them? ([Lesson #6, “They Straightway Left Their Nets,”](#) accessed 2/13/15.)

Recommended Reading:

1. James E. Talmage, *Jesus the Christ*, Chapter 13; click Read Online.
2. Chart 13-4: “[Four Lists of the Original Twelve Apostles](#),” from *Charting the New Testament*. [Note: Jude and Thaddeus are the same person.]

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